

Insights & Persona

Hair ICP – Stage 2 vs Stage 3

Based on: 272 S2 male responses + 306 S3 male responses + 213 customer call verbatims + 60 NPS responses

1. Who They Are

	Stage 2	Stage 3
Age	18–26 yrs (67% of base). Students and working professionals.	22–34 yrs. Working professionals dominate.
Occupation	Students ~45%, Private sector ~30%, Engineers ~9%	Private sector ~40%, Students ~28%, Business/freelance ~12%
Hair condition	Frontal recession, mild thinning. 54% reduced density. 30% are actually preventive (S1).	Crown + frontal loss visible. 78% reduced density. 7% are actually S4. Bald patches present.
Emotional distress	6.8/10. Fear-driven but manageable.	7.2/10. Higher distress. Crown loss harder to hide.
Doctor visit rate	25% visited a dermat before MM.	41% visited a dermat before MM. More clinical-minded.
Kit purchase	Partial kit / BG-only common. Gummies as entry hook.	61% buy full kit. 31% buy partial/BG-only (high churn risk).

One-Line ICP

- **S2:** 18–26 yr old student/young professional who spots frontal recession, sees a relatable Instagram ad, gets his friend’s confirmation, and buys hoping to stop losing what he has. Will panic at shedding in week 3 and quit before month 2 if no one tells him it’s normal.
- **S3:** 22–34 yr old working professional with visible crown + frontal loss, who has already tried Thriveco/Traya/home remedies and been disappointed. Researches on Gemini + YouTube + reviews. Buys the full kit hoping for bald-patch regrowth. Will silently churn in month 2–3 if doctor doesn’t deliver a specific milestone roadmap.

2. What They’re Actually Buying

	Stage 2	Stage 3
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Core motivation	PRESERVATION. “Jitne hai utne bachana chahta hoon.” Insurance against S3.	REVERSAL. “Bald patches pe baal wapas chahiye.” Get back what’s already gone.
What they expect	Hairfall stops. What I have stays. Quick signal in 4–6 weeks.	Baby hair on bald spots. Visible regrowth. Specific month-by-month milestones from the doctor.
Messaging that works	“Baal bachao” not “baal ugao.” “Abhi shuru nahi kiya toh Stage 3 tak pahunch jaoge.”	“Bald areas mein wapas aana.” Month 4–6 crown recovery journey. Before/after on bald patches.

3. What They Were Doing Before MM

Pre-MM cluster	Stage 2	Stage 3
Did nothing	43% – first-time treaters. Ignored until mirror shock or mummy noticed.	31% – ignored for 1.5–2 years. External trigger (wedding, job, mirror) finally broke the pattern.
Oils / home remedies	16%. Coconut, onion, castor oil. “Kuch nahi hua 6 months mein.”	18%. More varieties tried for longer. Desperate attempts including “secret website oils.”
OTC shampoos	12%. Clinic Plus, H&S, Pilgrim. Dandruff relief only.	14%. Same. Shampoo-only approach = known failure for S3.
D2C brand switcher	14%. Plix, Thriveco, Pilgrim, Traya. “Thriveco ka koi result nahi.”	22% – HIGHEST cluster. Brand-burned and skeptical. Traya: “too complex.” Thriveco: “no result.”
Dermat / Rx	8%. Local dermat, generic minox. Moved online for convenience.	10%. PRP tried and failed. Generic minox tried. MM brand trust > pharmacy generic.
Key insight	Most are clinical first-timers. Low research, impulse + peer nudge.	Most have tried and failed at least once. High research, skeptical, need more proof.

4. How They Find Us + Convert

	Stage 2	Stage 3
#1 trigger	Relatable Instagram/YT ad (37%). “Ad mein mera same situation tha.”	Friend/family result evidence (35%). Must SEE visible result on friends, not just recommendation.
#2 trigger	Friend/roommate recommendation (32%). “Dost ne mangwaya. 4 log mere circle mein use karte hain.”	Relatable ad + reviews loop (35%). Ad alone not enough. Needs comments section, reviews validation.
#3 trigger	Mirror shock / visible hairfall (20%). Photo or video call reveals hairline.	Full protocol promise (25%). “MM ka full system tha – shampoo, spray, gummies, roller, doctor.”
Conversion journey	SHORT. 1 relatable ad + 1 friend’s nod = purchase. Single-step works.	LONG. Ad → YouTube research → Gemini/ChatGPT comparison → reviews → friend proof → doctor promise.
Research depth	Low. Instagram ad + friend. Price check, not ingredient check.	High. Compares MM vs Traya on Gemini. YouTube journey videos month 3–6. Reads comment sections.
Primary channel	Instagram ads (discovery + conversion).	Instagram (discovery) + YouTube (research) + Gemini/ChatGPT (validation) + Friend result (closer).
Competitor threat	Bare Anatomy (“cheaper + 4 week claim”).	Traya (“more clinical, more thorough”). Transplant as parallel option for advanced S3.

5. Purchase Drivers

Functional

Driver	Stage 2	Stage 3
Primary goal	Stop hairfall (65%). “Save what I have.”	Regrowth on bald patches (70%). “Reverse what’s gone.”

Doctor credibility	55%. Free consult = #1 reason for choosing MM.	60%. Doctor 41%. NPS promoters: “Doctor consultation helpful” = top reason.
Safety / tested	48%. “Too many chemicals” = #1 put-off. Needs reassurance.	45%. Already past chemical anxiety. Wants proof of safety, not avoidance.
Simple routine	30%. “Traya ka login tough. MM ka simple – Do hi products.”	Less relevant. 61% buy full kit. Accepts complexity if it works.
Price point	28%. Budget ₹500–1K (50%). ₹900 = low barrier.	25%. Budget ₹500–1K (56%). Cost anxiety grows over 6-month protocol.

Emotional

Driver	Stage 2	Stage 3
Confidence	70%. #1 across all S2 data.	72%. #1 across all S3 data. Higher distress (7.2 vs 6.8/10).
Social judgment	45%. “Side se udde huwe lagte hai.” Cap to hide hairline.	45%. Crown loss harder to hide. Every cap-removal = anxiety event.
Dating / career	40%. Presentability, interview anxiety, dating confidence.	22% dating, 30% “look young.” Crown loss = age-marker. Career image acute.
Genetic anxiety	20%. “Papa ka tha.” Knows where it’s going.	10%. Less about genetics, more about reversing visible loss now.

6. Barriers & Frictions

Barrier	Stage 2	Stage 3
Results too slow	55%. #1 frustration. “Results take too long” = 29/94. Most in shedding phase – education failure, not product failure.	60%. #1 frustration. “No growth on bald spots after 3 months.” Bald patch regrowth needs 4–6 months. 58% rate 1–2/5.

Usage confusion	40%. Every cohort. “Minox baalo pe ya scalp pe?” 38% dose correctly, 21% overdose, 15% underdose.	Equally high. Kit more complex: product sequencing, dermaroller timing, shampoo-before-minox not communicated.
Shedding panic	35%. Week 2–6 hairfall not warned. “Baal kyu jhadenge?” = product failure in user’s mind.	30%. Even more alarming at S3 – already anxious. Additional shedding without warning = catastrophic.
Routine gaps	30%. “Forgot to apply.” Travel, dirty hair, winter night application.	28%. More holistically engaged but still struggles with daily routine.
Cost	22%. “Bahut mahanga 6 months ke liye.” Budget ₹500–1K.	25%. Longer treatment + more products. Cost anxiety grows without visible results.
Side effects fear	20%. “Minoxidil se addiction hoga.” Mostly pre-use, resolves with doctor.	Lower. Already decided on medication. Fear = long-term dependency, not initial safety.
Doctor gap	12%. “Free call band ho gayi after bulk order.”	25%. “Doctor timeline baar baar badha deta hai.” Inconsistent quality = trust collapse.
Transplant exit	Not relevant.	8%. S3+ not seeing results research transplants. Hard to reactivate.

7. Three Strategic Truths Per Stage

Stage 2

- **1. They buy insurance, not regrowth.** “Jitne hai utne bachana.” “Stage 2 se Stage 3 nahi jaana.” But MM ads lead with regrowth (S3 creative). Structural messaging misalignment at scale.
- **2. Shedding phase is the #1 self-inflicted retention crisis.** ~55% of detractors cite slow results or unexpected hairfall. Not a product failure – zero pre-communication. Every dropout generates negative WoM that kills the referral engine (32% of S2 comes from friends).
- **3. Usage confusion is the most predictable churn accelerator.** Present in every cohort regardless of age, city, tier. Minox dosage: 38% correct, 21% overdose, 15% underdose. A Day-1 WhatsApp video eliminates this entirely.

Stage 3

- **1. They want regrowth, not preservation.** Opposite of S2. Bald patches visible. “Baby hair on bald areas by month 4–5” is the right creative. Doctor must set a credible milestone at first consult.
- **2. One ad is not enough – they’re deliberate researchers.** They’ve been burned before. Gemini, YouTube, comment sections. Full-funnel required: TOF ad → MOF comparison content → BOF friend proof + doctor promise.
- **3. Doctor consult sets expectations – if it fails, they churn.** Needs: specific month-by-month milestones, shedding warning, mandatory Month 3 check-in. “Doctor baar baar timeline badha deta hai – I don’t trust this.” Quality inconsistent across panel.

8. So What – Next Quarter Priorities

Messaging & Creative

- **S2 creative:** Preservation-first. “Abhi shuru nahi kiya toh Stage 3 tak pahunch jaoge.” Cap removal shock. Week-by-week hairfall reduction. Stop showing crown recovery in S2 ads.
- **S3 creative:** Bald-patch reversal. Month 4–6 crown area journey. Dedicated S3 ad set, not shared with S2. “Meri tarah jo Stage 3 mein unke liye yeh hai.”
- **Comparison content:** S3 buyers compare on Gemini/ChatGPT. Own this: blog, YouTube, structured data. Price + simplicity + doctor = our angle vs Traya.
- **Competitor framing:** Bare Anatomy = S2 threat. Traya = S3 threat. Different responses per stage.

Onboarding & Retention

- **Day 1 WhatsApp video:** 60-sec application demo + shedding phase warning. Non-negotiable for S2 + S3.
- **S2 Month 2 auto-trigger:** Doctor check-in. Highest churn moment. Usage audit + shedding status + expectations reset.
- **S3 Month 3 auto-trigger:** Doctor check-in. Bald patch regrowth starts month 3–4. Catches them before they quit.
- **Prescription on WhatsApp:** Within 30 min of every consult. Currently missing for many users.

Doctor Consult

- **S2:** Pre-empt shedding. 6-week hairfall reduction milestone. Hindi explanation for Tier 2/3.
- **S3:** Mandatory milestone map: Week 4–6 hairfall slows → Month 2–3 density up → Month 4–5 baby hair on crown → Month 6 visible regrowth. This = retention anchor.

- **Standardise:** “Traya ka doctor bahut descriptive tha – MM ka doctor time nahi deta.” Fix the inconsistency. Make milestone map mandatory output from every consult.
- **Decouple from order:** Tie consult to 6-month usage window, not order quantity.

Product & Protocol

- **S2 upsell:** Gummies = entry. Post-consult upsell to full protocol (minox + gummy + shampoo).
- **S3 BG-only rescue:** 31% buy partial – guaranteed detractors. Month 1 outreach: “Gummies alone won’t restore bald patches.”
- **Stage misclassification:** 30% of S2 = actually S1. 35% of S3 = closer to S2. 7% of S3 = actually S4. Doctor must flag and adjust.
- **Cetosomal upgrade:** Advanced layer positioned as “doctor-recommended upgrade” during consult. Key AOV lever.

Acquisition

- **S2:** Instagram-first. Single ad + friend referral. Vernacular Hindi for Tier 2/3. Peer referral program (32% comes from friends).
- **S3:** Full funnel. TOF ad → MOF YouTube/blog comparison → BOF friend proof + doctor promise. Single-step doesn’t work.
- **S3 YouTube:** Month 3–6 crown journey content = the S3 closer. Invest in S3-specific journey creators.